

RICHARD KWAKU OPOKU

Cloud Security Engineer · Cybersecurity Specialist · Full-Stack Developer

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Executive Profile

Final-year Computer Science & Engineering student specializing in cloud security architecture, defensive web engineering, and high-concurrency production systems. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) with 600+ hours of enterprise cloud training (AmaliTech AWS re/Start). Architected live web applications processing 7,800+ real transactions on hardened AWS EC2 infrastructure.

Core Technical Competencies

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, Lambda, Cognito, Amplify), Linux/Bash Administration, Nginx Reverse Proxy

Cybersecurity & Defense: OWASP Top 10 Web Defense, Network Scanning & Enumeration (Nmap), SQL Injection Mitigation, IAM Least-Privilege

Backend & API Engineering: Node.js, Express.js, TypeScript/JavaScript (ES6+), RESTful API Design, JWT/Session Auth, WebSockets, Paystack API

Frontend Engineering: React.js, Next.js 15 (App Router), Tailwind CSS, State Management, Responsive Mobile-First UI

Databases & Tooling: PostgreSQL, SQLite / Turso, MongoDB, Git/GitHub CI/CD, Postman, Relational Schema Design & ACID Transactions

Featured Production Software Systems

VoteEQ — Real-Time Voting & Payment Settlement Platform | *React, Node.js, Express, PostgreSQL/Turso* [🔗 Live Demo](#)
Paystack, AWS EC2, WebSockets

- Architected and deployed an institutional voting and ticketing platform adopted officially by the UMaT CS Student Association.
- Processed **7,800+ live transactions** with automated Paystack cryptographic webhook verification and idempotent database locks.
- Built real-time WebSocket broadcast feeds for leaderboard sync; hardened production EC2 with SSL, rate-limiting, and CORS guards.

KaiRova — Premium Streetwear E-Commerce & Showcase | *Next.js 15, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Framer* [🔗 Live Demo](#)
Motion, Vercel

- Built a responsive commercial product featuring dynamic category filtering, interactive product lookbooks, and modular components.
- Optimized frontend architecture with Next.js App Router server components, delivering sub-second page transitions and fluid mobile UX.

Scholar — Academic Records & Administration Portal | *Next.js, TypeScript, React, REST APIs, Role-Based* [🔗 Live Demo](#)
Access Control

- Engineered an administrative portal implementing granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) and structured student record analytics.

AI Hospital Queue Manager — Hackathon Project | *React, AWS Lambda, Amazon API Gateway, Amazon* [🔗 Live Demo](#)
Cognito, DynamoDB

- Led cloud architecture in a 4-person team to build a serverless clinical queue system with AWS Cognito auth and DynamoDB persistence.

Professional Experience & Technical Leadership

AmaliTech — AWS re/Start Cloud Practitioner Program Takoradi / Online, Ghana
Cloud Practitioner Trainee & Intern Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

- Completed 600+ hours of enterprise cloud systems training spanning AWS architecture, Linux administration, and Python automation.
- Configured Virtual Private Clouds (VPC), multi-tier subnet routing, security groups, and automated S3 logging with least-privilege IAM.

AmaliTech Coding Club, UMaT Tarkwa, Ghana
Club Organizer & Technical Lead Mentor Jan 2026 – Present

- Facilitated technical bootcamps, algorithmic challenge labs, and code reviews for over **100 engineering students**.
- Mentored junior developers in defensive programming hygiene, Git/GitHub collaborative workflows, and RESTful API engineering.

UMaT Cybersecurity Club Tarkwa, Ghana
Active Technical Member Jan 2026 – Present

- Conducted weekly practical offensive/defensive labs focusing on network host discovery, port scanning with Nmap, and SQLi mitigation.

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, UMaT Tarkwa, Ghana
Teaching Assistant & Peer Tutor (C# & Data Structures) 2025 – Present

- Tutored undergraduate students in object-oriented programming (C#), algorithmic complexity, memory management, and databases.

Education & Industry Certifications

University of Mines and Technology (UMaT) Tarkwa, Ghana
BSc in Computer Science and Engineering — Year 4 (Final Year) 2024 – Expected June 2027

- **Academic Standing:** First Class Honours | Cumulative Weighted Average (**80.87 / 100 CWA**).
- **Core Coursework:** Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Database Systems, Cryptography, Software Engineering, Embedded Systems.

Professional Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CCP) ([Credly Verified](#)) · ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) · Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (Coursera / One Million Coders, In Progress) · Machine Learning Specialization (DeepLearning.AI / Stanford, [Verified](#)).